

Spurs' Cohen Shackles Blues With 14 Strikeouts, Four Hits

By WOODROW PAIGE JR.

They were asking who Randy Cohen was related to before the game, but afterwards they went away wondering who was akin to him.

The Dallas-Fort Worth pitcher discovered several cousins among the Memphis Blues last night as he struck out 14 and breezed to a 6-2 Texas League victory.

He made one mistake — a home run pitch to Blues second baseman Billy Carthel, who crossed home behind Curtis Brown in the second. Brown had walked.

A man telephoned Cohen yesterday morning to ask if he was related to Andy Cohen, a pitcher in the old Southern Association. He wasn't. Then, before the game, Dallas-Fort Worth manager Joe Altobelli said there was a possibility that Cohen might be related to showman George M. Cohen.

It made no difference as the righthand-

er, who gave up four hits and evened his record at 6-6, struck down the Blues this way: a strikeout in the second, two in the third, fourth, fifth, sixth and ninth innings and three in the seventh. The performance tied the league's top strikeout efforts this season, held jointly by Tom Bradley of El Paso and Steve Stone of Amarillo.

The win was the first of the four-game series for the Spurs. Memphis had won the two previous contests. Ray Ewing (1-3) will face the Spurs' Wayne Garland (4-8) in the finale at 7 tonight at Blues Stadium.

A crowd of 1,458 watched the Spurs jump to a 4-0 lead in the top of the second. Fred Reahm, the Memphis starter, walked three batters, gave up an infield hit and left the same following a bases-clearing double by Steve Green.

Carthel's homer closed the gap to 4-2 in the bottom half of the frame, but the Blues didn't scratch again. Dallas-Fort Worth pushed across single runs in the fourth and seventh to widen the gap to its eventual margin.

The loss cost the Blues a half-game in their fight for the league's Eastern Division lead. Arkansas, which tops the division, split a doubleheader with El Paso at Little Rock. The Travs won the opener, 4-2, but dropped the nightcap, 9-8. In other games, Shreveport downed Amarillo, 6-4, and San Antonio lost at Albuquerque 12-2.

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